

STUDENT DEMONSTRATIONS

The top priority of Loudoun County Public Schools is the safety and security of students and staff. Student demonstrations (e.g., walkouts) are permitted unless they lead to, or are likely to lead to, substantial disruption or material interference with instructional time, school activities, or an invasion of the rights of others. Students who participate in any demonstrations must do so in a peaceful and orderly manner and must govern their conduct in accordance with the *LCPS Student Rights and Responsibilities for Families and Student Code of Conduct* (SR&R).

A. General Considerations.

1. In advance of student demonstrations, students must coordinate with building administration to ensure a safe and secure environment; failure to do so can result in the demonstration not being permitted. Given that such demonstrations are not school-sponsored activities, flyers and/or signage promoting such demonstrations are not allowed.

2. Each school will provide a safe and supervised space for students to exercise their freedom of expression, which will be a designated area inside of the school or an area outside of the school that is not in public view or otherwise publicly accessible. For school safety and security, no school visitors will be allowed to participate in—or be present during—student demonstrations.

3. Any student participating in a demonstration must do so during non-instructional time and in a manner that does not or is not likely to create a substantial disruption to school operations, school activities, and/or the school environment. If it is determined that a school does not have sufficient staff resources and supervision to provide for a demonstration, the building administrator can either deny permission for a demonstration to take place or direct that a demonstration be concluded. If a student participates in a demonstration when they have an obligation to be in class, such participation will result in an unexcused absence in accordance with the SR&R. The school will notify the parent of such unexcused absence, consistent with Policy 8140, Student Attendance Requirements and Procedures.

4. Student demonstrations must not invade the rights of other students or otherwise violate Policy 8210 (Introduction to Student Discipline). For example, any demonstration that involves hate speech, highly offensive or threatening speech, or speech that distracts from the Board's mission of instilling values necessary or

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appropriate for polite civil discourse or political expression in a school context, social tolerance, nondiscrimination, self-awareness and sensitivity to the feelings of others will be prohibited and/or directed to conclude.

5. Schools will collaborate with the Department of Communications and Community Engagement to determine whether a community message will be circulated after a student demonstration, in accordance with Regulation 3070 (Communications Response Matrix). The Department of Communications and Community Engagement will directly communicate with any outside media requesting to cover a student demonstration.

B. Signs, Flags, Pictures, Banners, and All Other Visual Props. Because student demonstrations are not school-sponsored activities, signs, flags, pictures, banners, and all other visual props will not be permitted as part of a demonstration, particularly given their propensity to pose safety, security, and operational concerns.

Adopted: 10/21/2024

Cross Refs: Policy [7524](#), Staff Participation in Political Activities
Policy [8273](#), Student Speech and Expression
Policy [8140](#), Student Attendance Requirements and Procedures
Policy [8210](#), Introduction to Student Discipline